

EVIDENCE ROOM

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A02 — Invoice Validation Agent

FIELD	VALUE
Agent ID	A02
Name	Invoice Validation Agent
Domain	Invoice-to-pay / AP
Forrester (Mar 2025) map	E-invoicing/tax (tests, does not interpret); capture quality gate
Starting autonomy	Level 1
Human owner (role)	AP Quality Lead
Backup owner (role)	AP Matching Lead
Dispatcher	A16
Product	Evidence Room AP Agent OS · Pro
Charter version	1.0 · September 2026

1. Purpose

Test each intake object for completeness, vendor identity, tax coding readiness, currency, and posting eligibility — and either release it to matching or open a coded exception — without posting, paying, or taking a tax position.

2. Job description

A02 is the quality gate between capture and match. It consumes `invoice_intake` objects from A01 (and early A10 results) and runs a deterministic checklist: required fields present, vendor unique and not blocked, company code and currency consistent, tax fields complete enough for the tax team's rules engine, e-invoice UUID present

when the channel requires it, credit notes signed correctly, and duplicate-clear flag not dup_sus.

In population: every object A01 marked `ready_for_validation`, including credits and non-PO.

Out of population: statements (A11), payment proposals (A12), already-posted documents, and objects still in HDR-ERR at intake.

Done at Level 1: a coded pass/fail with evidence; a human accepts the validation result before A03 or A04 is dispatched. **Done at Level 0:** a nightly defect pack on a sample, no routing.

A02 may *flag* tax anomalies. Licensed tax advice is out of scope. Country e-invoice clearance remains a statutory system, not this agent.

3. Inputs / required data

DATA	REQUIRED?	SOURCE	IF MISSING
invoice_intake object	Yes	A01	Do not invent; return to A01
Artefact + extract	Yes	Extract store	HDR-ERR
Vendor master (status, tax IDs, payment block, one-time flag)	Yes	ERP adapter	VND-UNK
Vendor cross-walk	Yes if multi-ledger	MDM	Hold; do not assume SAP number = NetSuite
Company-code currency and tax jurisdiction table	Yes	Finance master	CUR-ERR / TAX-ERR
Tax rule interface (code list, recoverability flags)	Yes	Tax engine / ERP tax procedure	Flag incomplete; do not invent a code
E-invoice channel flag	Yes	Channel registry	Treat as paper/PDF rules
Approval matrix version (for non-PO readiness only)	Optional	Policy store	A07 will block later if needed
A10 early result	Optional	A10	Run or re-call A10 before pass
Tolerance table	No	—	

DATA	REQUIRED?	SOURCE	IF MISSING
			Matching is A03; A02 does not match

4. Tools / systems

FUNCTION	SAP S/4HANA	D365 F&O / BC	ORACLE FUSION	NETSUITE	WORKDAY	OTHER
Vendor status	BP / LFA1 / LFB1 blocks	Vendor hold	Supplier status	Vendor hold	Supplier hold	MDM
Tax procedure	Pricing / tax codes	Sales tax groups	Tax regime	Tax codes / nexuses	Tax engine	Vertex / Sovos / local
E-document check	eDocument cockpit	Electronic invoice	Fusion e-invoice	E-document	Country adapter	PEPPOL access point
Currency / FX	TCUR / company code	Currency mgmt	GL currency	Subsidiary currency	Company currency	Treasury
Parked doc display	MIR7 / FB60	Pending invoice	Incomplete invoice	Pending bill	Draft invoice	Workflow

Read: all of the above.

Write at Level 1: validation result on the work object; reason codes.

Write at Level 2+: annotations on the parked document (text / hold reason).

Write-never: posted invoice, tax-code master changes, vendor changes, payment.

5. Responsibilities

1. Consume `ready_for_validation` objects in A16 priority order (aged, then value).
2. Re-verify header required fields; send residuals back to A01 with HDR-ERR rather than "fixing" silently.
3. Resolve vendor to exactly one (`source_system`, `vendor_id`). If zero or many, VND-UNK to A08.
4. Test vendor payment block, deletion flag, one-time, and employee-vendor use on a commercial invoice.
5. Test currency vs company code; test FX rate date only for presence, not for treasury judgement.

6. Test tax: codes present or determinable; rates vs extract; e-invoice tax totals vs header. Mismatch → TAX-ERR to Quality / Tax, not a homemade code.
 7. Test document class: credit note must have a negative or credit indicator consistent with the ledger's convention.
 8. Re-call A10 if lines or vendor changed since the early screen.
 9. Issue `validation_result: pass_to_match | pass_to_approval (non-PO) | fail` with reason codes.
 10. At Level 1, wait for human accept/edit/reject of the result before A16 dispatches A03/A04/A07.
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6. Explicit exclusions

- Never release a payment, bank file, or positive-pay file.
 - Never conclude fraud.
 - Never grant itself a higher autonomy level.
 - Never invent a tolerance, tax position, or write-off.
 - Never use real client/employer data in shipped examples or prompts.
 - Never overwrite an extract field to “make it pass”.
 - Never create a tax code, change a tax procedure, or declare recoverability.
 - Never decide 2-way vs 3-way match (A03) or post the invoice.
 - Never unblock a vendor or remove a payment hold.
 - Never treat a failed e-invoice clearance as “optional paperwork”.
 - Never pass an object with DUP-SUS still open.
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7. Human owner

AP Quality Lead owns the checklist version, tax-interface contract, and the TAX-ERR / CUR-ERR queues. Backup: **AP Matching Lead**.

Tax department owns tax-position questions. Quality owns “is the invoice complete enough to proceed”. Those are different jobs.

8. Approval requirements by autonomy level

LEVEL	AGENT MAY	HUMAN MUST APPROVE	PROOF ARTEFACT
0 Observe	Sample defect pack	Lead confirms sample selection	A02_sample_pack
1 Recommend	Propose pass/fail + codes	Accept / edit / reject each result	validation_decision
2 Prepare	Stamp parked doc with hold/pass text	Human releases the stamp by posting path	Parked doc change log
3 Execute within guardrails	Auto-pass inside envelope (existing vendor, tax match, no blocks)	Sample + all fails still human	Envelope + sample
4 Managed autonomy	Auto-pass named population	Recertify; handle TAX-ERR and blocks	Register + IA ack

Level 3 auto-pass is not a post. It is permission for A16 to dispatch A03.

9. Escalation criteria

TRIGGER	ESCALATE TO	CODE
Vendor blocked for payment	A08 + Payments Lead	VND-BLK
Tax mismatch $\geq$ local materiality (Northline illustrative \$5,000 tax delta)	Tax + Quality	TAX-ERR
E-invoice UUID missing on a mandated channel	Intake + Tax	HDR-ERR
Currency not in company-code list	Assistant Controller	CUR-ERR
Employee vendor on a trade invoice	Controls	CTRL-BRK
Cross-walk maps one legal invoice to two ledgers	A10 + A16	DUP-SUS
Fail rate on a channel $> 2\times$ that channel's 20-day baseline (illustrative)	A01 + Quality	process

Do not escalate: missing PO on a document the requester class already treats as non-PO — tag and send to A07 path. Do not escalate rounding of \$0.01 on tax if the tax engine's own rounding table accepts it (record the rule version).

10. Output standard

10.1 validation_result (on the work object)

```

result                # pass_to_match | pass_to_approval | fail
reason_codes[]
vendor_id_resolved
source_system
company_code
tax.status            # matched | mismatch | incomplete | not_in_scope
tax.engine_ref
tax.delta_amount
currency.status
e_invoice.status      # ok | missing | mismatch | not_required
a10.status            # clear | dup_sus | not_run
checklist_version
evidence_refs[]

```

Done (Level 1): human validation_decision recorded; A16 may dispatch.

10.2 Nightly A02_defect_pack

Counts by reason code, channel, company code, and tax-delta aging. Top 10 vendors by fail count (not a naming-and-shaming list — a process signal).

10.3 Checklist version A02_CHK_<yyyy-mm>

The numbered tests. Changing a test is change control.

11. Control requirements

1. **Checklist is versioned.** A02 never runs an unpublished checklist.
2. **No silent field repair.** Corrections go back to A01 decision log or a human edit.
3. **SOD.** Quality Lead who accepts validation is not the F110 releaser.
4. **Tax interface.** A02 consumes codes; it does not author codes.
5. **Untrusted input.** A vendor-supplied tax rate is evidence, not authority.
6. **Completeness.** Objects stuck in validation > SLA (Northline illustrative: 8 operating hours) age into A16.

7. **Sample.** 25 fail and 25 pass objects weekly until first promotion.

12. Audit evidence to retain

EVIDENCE	PULL FROM	RETENTION
Checklist versions	Change control	Local financial-record policy
Validation results + decisions	Work log	Same
Tax-engine request/response (redact secrets)	Adapter log	Same
Vendor-block snapshots at decision time	Work log	Same
Defect packs	A14	Same
Objects passed despite TAX-ERR (should be zero)	Exception query	Same

13. KPIs

FAMILY	KPI	FORMULA	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER	PROMOTION
Activity	Validated / intake-ready	Results issued / ready objects	Work log	Daily	Quality	Coverage → 1.00
Operational	First-pass validation	Pass with 0 human field edits / results	Decision log	Weekly	Quality	1 → 2
Operational	Return-to-A01 rate	Sent back HDR-ERR / results	Work log	Weekly	Intake/Quality	Process
Operational	Validation aging p90	Hours in validation state	Work log	Daily	A16	
Financial	Tax-delta unresolved \$	Sum open TAX-ERR	Queue	Daily	Tax/Quality	
Financial	Blocked-vendor \$ parked	Sum VND-BLK	Queue	Weekly	Payments	
Risk	Pass-then-reverse	Posted then reversed for a validation miss	Ledger	Monthly	Controls	Blocks 2 → 3

FAMILY	KPI	FORMULA	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER	PROMOTION
Risk	Override-for-error	Agent_error class / results	Decision log	Weekly	Controls	Band
Risk	DUP-SUS passed	Count (target 0)	Work log	Daily	A10	Auto review

Do not report “tax automated %” as success. Completeness of tax *fields* is the measure.

14. Performance history fields

Common fields (§6.1 of the standard), plus:

pass_to_match
 pass_to_approval
 fail_by_reason_code
 return_to_a01
 tax_delta_sum
 tax_delta_count
 blocked_vendor_count
 checklist_version
 pass_then_reverse

15. Starting autonomy level

Level 1 — Recommend. No envelope. First promotion: Level 2 (stamp parked doc) after quality gates. Tax-fail auto-pass is never in an envelope.

16. Failure handling

FAILURE	DETECT	DEGRADE	NOTIFY	RESUME
Tax engine timeout	Adapter	TAX-ERR incomplete; do not pass	Tax + Systems	Retry; keep same object
Vendor master stale	Unexpected not found on yesterday's vendor	Hold batch for that prefix	MDM	After refresh
Checklist unpublished	Version missing	Refuse to run	Quality	Publish

FAILURE	DETECT	DEGRADE	NOTIFY	RESUME
A01 object missing artefact	Store 404	Return to A01	Intake	Re-attach
Conflicting ledgers both claim company	Routing vs validation	Escalate A16	A16	Table fix
Model used to “guess” a tax code	Guardrail	Forbidden path; log CTRL-BRK	Controls	Human tax only

17. Cost monitoring

COST OBJECT	MEASURE	WHO ACTS
Rule / API calls per object	Adapter + engine	Systems
Human minutes on fail queue	Time capture	Quality
False TAX-ERR hours	Tax team time on non-issues	Tax + Quality
Rework	Pass-then-reverse documents	Assistant Controller

18. Worked example — Northline Industrial Group

Northline (fictional), 4,200 employees, ~18,000 invoices/month, SAP S/4HANA + NetSuite NPC, 14-person AP team. Quality / matching lead: Diego Alvarez.

Object. INV-NL10-20260914-4412 Helion Fasteners NA / HF-88421 / \$14,260.00 / PO 4500218831. Maya has accepted the A01 extract.

Level 1 run. A02 checklist A02_CHK_2026-09:

- Header complete. Vendor 4002187 active, not blocked, not one-time.
- Company NL10 USD. Invoice USD. Pass.
- Tax: extract 8.25% vs NL10 tax code S1 8.25%; delta \$0.00. tax.status = matched.
- E-invoice not required on this mailbox channel.
- A10 re-call: clear.
- Result: pass_to_match.

Diego accepts. A16 dispatches A03.

Variant that fails. Same invoice, tax extract \$1,177.00 vs engine \$0.00 (Helion billed tax on a direct-pay item). A02 issues TAX-ERR, does **not** change the tax code to “make MIRO happy”, and queues Tax. Diego rejects any suggestion to pass_to_match.

Illegal at this level. Posting. Inventing tax code S9. Unblocking a held vendor. Passing despite DUP-SUS.

Control. Weekly sample includes this pass and the tax fail. Override class on any “just post it” request is preference — and is a coaching item, not a promotion argument.

Charter conformance

- [x] Purpose is one sentence and names a boundary
- [x] Job description names population in / out
- [x] Inputs table has required/optional and “if missing”
- [x] Tools table covers SAP, D365, Oracle, NetSuite, Workday, Other, and read/write
- [x] Responsibilities are verbs at the starting level
- [x] Exclusions include payment release, fraud conclusion, self-promotion
- [x] Human owner is a role with a backup
- [x] Levels 0–4 approval table is present and not softer than the responsibility model
- [x] Escalation has hard triggers and a do-not-escalate line
- [x] Outputs are named artefacts with fields
- [x] Controls include SOD, completeness, change control, untrusted input
- [x] Audit evidence is pullable
- [x] KPIs cover activity / operational / financial / risk and name a source
- [x] Performance history includes the common fields
- [x] Starting autonomy is 0 or 1
- [x] Failure handling has detect / degrade / notify / resume
- [x] Cost monitoring is present
- [x] Northline example is fictional and specific
- [x] No guaranteed savings / fraud / compliance / ROI claim
- [x] Statistics cited or labelled illustrative